

Property Buying Checklist: Punjab

Slow down before paying

Property purchases can involve title, possession, planning, tax, registration, inheritance, mortgage, and litigation issues. A seller's possession or copy of a document is not by itself complete proof of a safe transaction.

- Record the exact property description, area, boundaries, location, price, and proposed payment schedule.
- Confirm the seller's identity and authority to sell.
- Use independent verification rather than relying only on documents supplied by an agent or seller.
- Do not make a large non-refundable payment before document and record checks.

Important limitation

This guide is educational information, not a title opinion or legal advice. Rural land, urban property, housing schemes, allotments, leases, and inherited property may require different checks.

Identity and ownership trail

Match the person to the record

- Inspect original CNIC and compare names, parentage, signatures, and photographs across documents.
- If an attorney signs, verify the power of attorney, scope, registration, continued validity, and identity of the principal and attorney.
- For inherited property, identify all legal heirs and review succession or mutation material rather than relying on one heir's statement.
- For a company or society, confirm registration and the signatory's authority.

Review the title chain

Obtain and examine the available record of rights, mutations, registered instruments, allotment or transfer letters, and prior ownership documents. Names, measurements, khasra or plot details, boundaries, and shares should reconcile across the chain. Any break, correction, overwriting, unexplained transfer, or inconsistent area needs investigation.

Encumbrances, approvals, and site

Check what may affect the property

- Search for mortgages, charges, attachments, stay orders, acquisition, litigation, tenancy, easements, and unpaid dues.
- Confirm the relevant development authority or scheme approval and the permitted land use.
- Obtain current no-demand or no-dues information where the relevant authority provides it.
- Visit the site, measure it through a qualified person, compare boundaries, and ask who is in actual possession.
- Speak independently with neighbors or occupants where appropriate.

Punjab Land Records Authority describes its Green Property Certificate process as checking identity through CNIC and biometrics, ownership and transaction history, taxes or dues, mortgage or court orders, physical possession and boundaries, and a public-notice stage. Availability and suitability should be confirmed for the property concerned.

Agreement, payment, and completion

Put the deal in writing

A carefully drafted agreement should identify the parties and property, price, deposit, payment method, completion date, documents to be delivered, taxes and fees, possession, default consequences, refund conditions, representations, and dispute process.

- Pay through traceable banking channels and obtain signed receipts.
- Do not understate consideration or accept false declarations.
- Confirm who bears stamp duty, registration charges, taxes, society fees, and transfer costs.
- Coordinate signing, payment, registration or transfer, and delivery of possession.
- Obtain originals, keys, possession evidence, updated records, and utility handover documents at completion.

Registration and mutation serve different record functions. Ask a qualified professional which instruments and post-completion changes are required for the property type.

Final file and official sources

Keep one complete transaction file

- Identity and authority documents.
- Title chain and official record searches.
- Scheme or authority approvals and dues status.
- Site report, measurements, photographs, and possession notes.
- Signed agreement, registered instrument, receipts, tax and fee evidence.
- Updated mutation, society, authority, and utility records where applicable.

Official sources checked July 2026

- Punjab Land Records Authority, Green Property Certificate process:
<https://www.punjab-zameen.gov.pk/gpcinfo>
- Punjab Land Records Authority: <https://www.punjab-zameen.gov.pk/>
- Punjab Law Portal information: https://www.pitb.gov.pk/law_portal

Official processes, fees, and required documents can change. Verify current requirements directly with the relevant land-record center, registration office, development authority, society, and tax authority before committing funds.